

MANCALA

VARIANT LIBRARY

The world's most-played family of count-and-capture games

8	2	6+
VARIANTS	PLAYERS	AGE

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Mancala is a family of count-and-capture games originating in Africa and the Middle East, with a history spanning at least 3,000 years. Players sow seeds or stones around a board of pits, capturing when sowing lands in the right conditions. The same fundamental mechanic produces dozens of culturally distinct games across Africa, Asia, and the Caribbean.

This library includes 8 playable variants from across the Mancala family.

WEST AFRICA

- ♦ [Oware](#) — The most widely known Mancala game: 2×6 pits, single-lap sowing, grand slam rule
- ♦ [Ayo](#) — Yoruba (Nigerian) form of Oware with identical rules and deep cultural tradition

EAST AFRICA

- ♦ [Bao](#) — The most complex Mancala: 4-row board, multi-lap sowing, relay captures

SOUTHEAST ASIA

- ♦ [Congkak](#) — Malaysian 2×7 board with two houses; sow into own store, skip opponent's
- ♦ [Sungka](#) — Philippine 2×7 board; simultaneous start, sow into own head only

SOUTH ASIA

- ♦ [Pallanguzhi](#) — Tamil Nadu: 2×7 pits, 12 seeds per pit, multi-lap sowing with relay capture

CENTRAL ASIA

- ♦ [Toguz Korgool](#) — Kyrgyz national game: 2×9 pits, tuzduk rule locks one opponent pit

WESTERN STANDARD

- ♦ [Kalah](#) — The 1940s Western standardisation: 2×6 pits plus two stores, accessible and fast



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